

Kickoff Briefing — The Recap

Everything we covered on the call, in one place

WHEN	HOW LONG	WHO SPOKE
Friday, 10 July 2026 1:47pm (GMT+8)	About 50 minutes	Clement Hing & Catch22 (the C22 partners)

Who is C22

A data and strategy company whose first product happens to be in trading. The real focus is behavioral finance — finding the repeatable, irrational things traders do under pressure and turning them into systematic strategies. When C22 spots a trader about to make a predictable mistake, it takes the opposite side of their trade in real time — and the engine currently runs at a win rate of roughly 60+%. All data is created inside C22's own ecosystem; nothing is bought or rented.

Two things C22 lives by:

- A finding only counts if it survives proper out-of-sample testing.
- The rules of a system change how people behave inside it — keep this in mind, it matters for the project.

The data you'll be playing with

Everything comes from C22's own trading challenge — a prop-firm-style evaluation where traders try to hit a profit target on simulated accounts, with real funding and a profit split waiting if they pass. The catch: strict rules, and breaking one kills the account instantly.

- **The rules:** hit an 8% return within 24 hours, never exceed a 4% drawdown, keep position sizing consistent, and no adding to losing trades.
- **The instrument:** gold (XAU/USD) CFDs only — because that's where the retail day-trading crowd (and every YouTube guru) lives.
- **The size:** around 30 challenge campaigns, all anonymized. Not huge, but genuinely unique — 24-hour prop-challenge behavioral data doesn't exist anywhere else.

Why it's special

Every decision — entry, exit, lot size, timing, direction, P&L, drawdown, every rule breach — is labeled with its outcome, and each breach is a named behavior. The emotions are real because real money is on the line. And since everyone trades the same instrument under the same rules in the same 24-hour window, any difference in behavior is the trader, not the market. Labeled, genuine, isolated, complete — very hard to find elsewhere.

Your mission

The work breaks down into four parts:

- **Dig into the data** and uncover the behavioral patterns — revenge trading, size escalation, adding to losers, betting too much on one idea.
- **Build a strategy framework** that can actually exploit what you find.
- **Think about the rules themselves** — if you have a strong, well-backed idea for how the challenge design could produce better data, C22 will genuinely consider changing it.
- **Simulate, evaluate, and recommend** — test your ideas under different scenarios and say what you'd do.

Use whatever approach you like — machine learning, statistics, rule-based systems, anything. Nobody cares which technique you reach for, only that the result works and is properly validated. Out-of-sample, walk-forward testing counts just as much as raw accuracy. A gorgeous backtest that falls apart on unseen data scores nothing.

How the 12 weeks play out

Stage (2 weeks each)	What you're doing	What you hand in
1. Data Exploration	Get to know the dataset, clean it, profile the behavior, form your first hypotheses. Starts today.	EDA memo
2. Feature Engineering	Turn raw trade events into behavioral signals — this is where the edge lives.	Documented feature set
3. Model Building	Build your models on the historical data provided.	Model & backtest results
4. Live Validation	Test on new data — historical first, then hidden. Nobody touches production until validated.	Frozen model
5. Research Defense	Explain why your model works, where it fails, and how it adapts.	Your pitch
6. Production Candidate	The strongest work moves toward production research with C22, beyond the program.	—

The checkpoints aren't busywork — they're how C22 keeps an eye on progress and steers you away from dead ends early, instead of finding out at the end. They also roll up naturally into the three graded finals: stages 1–3 become your **written report**, stages 2–4 become your **prototype**, and stage 5 is your **final presentation**. Nothing overly lengthy is expected — it's results that matter.

How you'll be judged

- **Technical quality** — how rigorous your analysis, modeling, and validation are.
- **Business value** — how relevant and useful your insights actually are to C22.
- **Practical implementation** — is it feasible, and does it hold up on unseen data?
- **Innovation** — how original your features and approach are. Don't sleep on this one.

The recurring theme: robustness beats a flattering backtest, every time. Tremendous backtest numbers only matter if they survive forward testing too.

What's in it for you

- Cash prizes for the best-scoring reports, whether you're solo or in a team.
- The real prize, if you're thinking ahead: build something that works and C22 will work with you to get it running as a live, profit-generating strategy — and keep you on for production research after the program ends.

Good questions people asked

How does C22 track behavior right now?

There's a tracker for every trader. As trades come in (time, direction, lot size...), the algorithm measures each trader against known behavior patterns. Say someone is down 2% of their 4% allowance — the system flags them as likely to start making mistakes, and when they open a trade matching that expected profile, C22 reverses it in real time. ML is used behind the scenes to study behavior and shape the rules, but what runs live today is rule-based — no full ML model in production yet. And if you ever want to test your ideas against C22's baseline, they'll pull the data and compare.

Can we use outside data or AI?

Yes to both. Bring in related datasets or use AI to enhance your model — as long as you can clearly explain what you did and your forward-tested results are good.

What about a bad trade that makes money?

Happens all the time — gold CFDs are volatile and luck is real. That's exactly why you need enough data behind any thesis. Quantify the behavior first, then judge from there whether a profitable trade was skill or variance. Clement's honest take: there are no genuinely good traders in this dataset — the winner will be whoever models the behavior most consistently.

What should the final prototype look like?

Any format you like, with one non-negotiable: it has to run in real time. C22 needs to watch your algorithm actually working live, validated on forward-tested data — otherwise it's not useful to them.

Housekeeping

- The info pack — anonymized datasets, a glossary, the challenge rule format — lands in your email (Google Drive link) shortly after the call, whether you joined today or are joining tomorrow.
- The data is proprietary. The NDA clause from the earlier email already covers you (no separate signing needed), so keep the data within your team.
- Teams were formed around complementary skill sets and your WhatsApp groups are already set up. Want a shuffle? Ask. Want to go full Iron Man solo? Also fine.
- Mentor check-ins happen on Mondays, on request — dates will be shared ahead of time.
- Questions anytime: drop them in the WhatsApp group, message Catch22 directly, or move the chat to Telegram. You can also book a call to sanity-check your direction.
- Missed today? The exact same briefing runs tomorrow.

Before you go

- **Stage 1 starts today** — watch your inbox for the dataset.
- First thing due: your **EDA memo with early hypotheses**, at the end of the two-week stage.

- Say hi to your team (or settle into your solo setup) and flag any team changes early.
- And keep the mantra in mind: **alpha lives in the behavior, not the price.**